

To become a **"Data-Driven Professional"** in your current role (without switching careers), you do not need to become a core programmer. Instead, you need to learn how to **connect your daily operations with data tools** to automate tasks and make smarter decisions.

Here is the exact knowledge required and a step-by-step roadmap tailored to your current work profile (Oracle, Excel, Hardware, and Design).

Phase 1: Core Knowledge Required (The "What" and "Why")

To be data-driven, you must master three areas:

1. **Data Analytics Thinking:** Understanding how to turn raw numbers into business insights (e.g., analyzing which laptop brand breaks down the most in your office).
 2. **Data Automation:** Knowing how to make different software systems talk to each other without manual copy-pasting.
 3. **Data Storytelling:** Presenting data using clean charts and dashboards so your manager can understand it instantly.
-

Phase 2: Step-by-Step Roadmap (6-Month Plan)

[Month 1: Advanced Excel] —> [Month 2: SQL & Oracle] —> [Month 3: SharePoint & Automation]



[Month 6: AI Integration] <— [Month 5: Data Visuals] <— [Month 4: System Integration]



Month 1: Master Modern Excel & Data Structuring

- **Goal:** Stop doing manual calculations and format data like a professional database.
- **What to learn:**
 - **Power Query:** To clean, combine, and transform messy Excel sheets automatically.
 - **XLOOKUP & Advanced Formulas:** For fast data merging.
 - **Pivot Tables & Charts:** For summarizing data instantly.
- **Your Practice Project:** Create a dynamic, automated asset tracker for the 8-10 computers you manage.



Month 2: SQL Basics & Database Concepts

- **Goal:** Understand how Oracle databases store data so you can pull reports easily.
- **What to learn:**
 - Basic SQL queries (SELECT, WHERE, GROUP BY).
 - Joining tables (INNER JOIN, LEFT JOIN).
 - How relational databases work.

- **Your Practice Project:** Write basic queries to extract specific order reports from your Oracle system instead of manually searching.

Month 3: Cloud Storage & Workflow Automation (SharePoint + Power Automate)

- **Goal:** Automate your daily repetitive data entry and file sharing tasks.
- **What to learn:**
 - **SharePoint Lists:** Using them as a cloud database to store office records.
 - **Power Automate Cloud Flows:** Setting up "Triggers" and "Actions" (e.g., *Trigger:* New file uploaded to SharePoint -> *Action:* Send an automatic email notification).
- **Your Practice Project:** Build a workflow where if someone requests a hardware repair, they fill out a form, and it automatically updates a SharePoint list and alerts you.

Month 4: Connecting the Dots (System Integration)

- **Goal:** Make Oracle, Excel, and SharePoint work together.
- **What to learn:**
 - Exporting data from Oracle directly into SharePoint or Excel.
 - Using Power Automate to read data from an incoming Excel file and log it into another system.

Month 5: Modern Data Visualization (Power BI or Tableau)

- **Goal:** Replace static text reports with interactive, visually stunning dashboards.
- **What to learn:**
 - Connecting Power BI to Excel or SharePoint lists.
 - Building simple bar charts, line graphs, and KPIs.
 - Publishing and sharing dashboards.
- **Your Practice Project:** Create a "Monthly Operations Dashboard" showing total orders processed, IT issues resolved, and social media post performance.

Month 6: AI-Assisted Workflows

- **Goal:** Use AI to do your creative and analytical work 10x faster.
- **What to learn:**
 - Using **ChatGPT/Claude** to write complex Excel formulas and SQL queries for you.
 - Using AI tools like **Gamma.app** to generate presentations from raw data.
 - Using **Canva AI** to generate social media poster designs using data-driven prompts.

By the end of this roadmap, you will not just be entering data—you will be the person who **manages, automates, and visualizes** the entire data flow of your department.

To help you take the first step, let me know:

- Which version of Excel do you use (**Excel 2019, 2021, or Microsoft 365**)?
- Do you have the freedom to **install or test Power BI/Power Automate** on your office computer?